religious institutions in and around the city, and Lahore grew rapidly both in extent and population.' Even outside the walls of Lahore, there were vast tracts covered in 'richly designed mosques, tombs, havelis and gardens of the aristocracy', though sadly no traces of these buildings remain today. Within the city walls, bazaars were built along the main roads, highly specialized according to the commodity sold. Incense and religious books were sold near the mosques, leather workers supplying book bindings were located nearby, as also the slipper bazaar. Further away were the cloth and embroidery bazaars as well as the jewellers, while furthest away were bazaars dealing in bulk commodities too cumbersome to convey through the narrow pedestrian streets such as wholesale grain and spices, wool, pottery, fresh products etc. Future generations of Padshahs and their families would add to the landscape and by the time Akbar's grandson, Shah Jahan, came to power the mythic Shalimar Gardens would be built and Lahore would become the City of Gardens.

The walled city of Lahore was built by the river Ravi, with the Shahi Qila overlooking the vast and busy river. There was a bridge of boats constructed over the river and a steady stream of vessels sailed up and down the Ravi, 'constantly carrying an infinity of supplies'. Across from the Shahi Qila was a huge tented encampment, where merchants from different countries brought their goods to sell to the people at the court in the city. There was a small mud island in the middle of the river where, every morning at dawn, crowds thronged to make their daily darshan of Akbar following which there would be animal fights arranged on the sandy banks to amuse the crowds and the Padshah.

If in Lahore Akbar was no longer as enthusiastic a patron of architecture, his devotion to miniature paintings remained undiminished. There was a change, nonetheless, in the type of works that the taswir khanas at Lahore would produce at this time. From the earlier large works that had been created, the focus would now be on a few volumes of Persian poetry, produced to a high degree of perfection, known as de luxe manuscripts. These small but exquisitely finished works, as perfect as a single liquid note of a nightingale, were produced using the very best artists and the purest and highest quality products of the land. There were new additions to the ranks of painters, local men with names like Ibrahim Lahori, Kalu Lahori, and the talented calligrapher, Muhammad Husayn al-Kashmiri, known as Zarrin Qalam (Golden Pen). In addition to these newer artists at work in